

Rules for the Board Game Tsuki (突棋), 16th Edition

A two-player deterministic abstract strategy game.

1 Setup

- (1) The standard board is an 8×8 grid. Two players sit facing each other across the board.
- (2) The nearest row to each player is called that player's back rank. The farthest row is the opponent's back rank.
- (3) There is only one type of piece. A player's pieces and the opponent's pieces are distinguished by a property. There are 8 of each by default.
- (4) Pieces can only be placed within squares, with at most one piece per square.
- (5) At the start of the game, each player places one of their pieces on each square of their back rank.

2 Turn order

- (1) A turn consists of one move of one of the player's pieces to a different square.
- (2) Players alternate turns, with the first player moving first.
- (3) Passing is prohibited.

3 Movement only

- (1) A piece can move any number of empty squares in one direction: $\searrow, \uparrow, \nearrow$. (“ $\uparrow$ ” means forward.)
- (2) A piece cannot move onto an occupied square, nor jump over another piece.

4 Capturing and movement

- (1) A piece can capture an opponent's piece and move onto its square only if that piece is exactly one square away in one of these directions: $\leftarrow, \searrow, \uparrow, \nearrow, \rightarrow$.
- (2) Captured pieces cannot be reused.

5 Winning the game

- (1) If one player resigns, the other player is the winner.
- (2) Other than "(1)", if one player commits a foul, and the other player does not make the next move and points out the foul, "the other player" is the winner.
- (3) Other than "(1) or (2)", if one player moves a piece onto the opponent's back rank and that piece is not captured on the opponent's next turn, the "one player" is the winner.

6 Notation

- (1) The first player is represented by " $\square$ ", and the second player by " $\square$ ".
- (2) From the first player's perspective, a square is denoted as "x.y" where the square is x-th from right to left ("x.") and y-th from the far side to the near side ("y").
- (3) The direction of movement is indicated by an arrow.
- (4) A move is written as:
" $\square$ (or $\square$), destination square, direction arrow."
Example: " $\square$ 2.3 $\nearrow$ ", " $\square$ 4.5 $\downarrow$ "